

Status and Approval Philosophy

Understand how statuses and approvals work together to create structured workflows

Overview

Statuses and approvals are fundamental design elements of Intain Markets that work together to create structured workflows where items progress through defined stages, quality is ensured through review checkpoints, and proper authorization is obtained before commitment. Understanding this philosophy helps you appreciate why the platform works the way it does, how statuses and approvals interact, and how to work effectively within the structured workflow system.

How the Platform Is Designed

The platform is designed around the principle that structured finance transactions must progress through logical stages, with quality checks and authorization gates at critical points. Statuses serve as markers that indicate where an item is in its journey, while approvals serve as gates that ensure quality and compliance before items can proceed to the next stage.

Statuses as Active Controls - Statuses are not arbitrary labels—they are active controls that:

- **Define what actions are available** - Only actions appropriate for the current stage are enabled. When you see a disabled button, it's usually because the status doesn't allow that action yet, or prerequisites haven't been met. This prevents errors and ensures proper workflow progression.
- **Prevent improper progression** - You cannot skip stages or go backwards without proper authorization. The platform enforces sequential progression, ensuring that important steps aren't missed and that items progress in the correct order.

- **Reflect business state** - Statuses represent real business conditions, not just technical states. A pool in "Preview" status is actually being shared for review, a term sheet in "FAReview" status is actually being reviewed by a facility agent, and a funding request in "APPROVED" status has actually been approved and is ready for the next stage.
- **Enable parallel workflows** - Different parties can work on different aspects while respecting status boundaries. An issuer can work on pool details while a market maker reviews the pool, but certain actions are only available when the status allows them.
- **Provide visibility** - Statuses communicate to all parties where items are in the process. Everyone can see the current status and understand what stage the item is at, what has happened, and what needs to happen next.

Approvals as Quality Assurance - Approvals are not obstacles—they are quality assurance mechanisms that:

- **Ensure standards are met** - Items are reviewed by qualified parties before proceeding. Reviewers examine items to ensure they meet quality requirements, identify issues early, and provide opportunities for improvement before final commitment.
- **Maintain compliance** - Regulatory requirements and business rule requirements are verified before commitment. Reviewers assess compliance, ensuring that transactions meet all necessary requirements before proceeding.
- **Protect all parties** - Approvals ensure all parties agree before commitment. Submitters know their items are reviewed, reviewers can ensure quality, and all parties benefit from structured review processes that protect everyone involved.
- **Enable improvement** - Reviewers can request changes before final approval, allowing iterative improvement. This enables refinement and ensures that items meet requirements before final commitment, rather than requiring rejection and restart.
- **Create accountability** - Approval decisions are documented and attributed to specific reviewers. This creates accountability and supports compliance requirements, ensuring that decisions are traceable and attributable.

The platform enforces this structure automatically, ensuring that workflows progress correctly and approvals happen in the proper sequence. This automatic enforcement reduces errors, ensures consistency, and maintains workflow integrity throughout the transaction lifecycle.

What This Enables for Users

For Submitters (issuers, borrowers), this structure provides clarity about what needs to happen next, ensures your submissions are reviewed by qualified parties, and protects you by requiring approvals before commitment. You can see where your items are in the process, understand what's required to move forward, and be confident that approved items have met quality and compliance standards. The structure also provides opportunities for feedback and improvement before final commitment.

For Reviewers (facility agents, market makers, lenders), this structure provides clear decision points, ensures you review items at the right stage, and gives you tools to request improvements before approval. You can see what needs your attention, make informed decisions, and ensure quality and compliance through structured review processes. The structure also ensures that you review items at the appropriate stage, when all necessary information is available.

For All Parties, this structure provides transparency into process progression, ensures quality through review, maintains compliance through structured workflows, and creates accountability through documented decisions. Everyone can see where things stand, what needs to happen next, and who is responsible for specific actions or decisions. This transparency builds trust and enables effective collaboration.

The status and approval structure enables efficient collaboration while maintaining quality, compliance, and proper authorization throughout the transaction lifecycle. This structure protects all parties while ensuring that transactions progress efficiently and correctly.

Key Principles to Understand

Statuses Control Actions - Statuses are not just informational—they actively control what you can do. When an action is disabled, it's usually because the status doesn't allow it yet, or prerequisites haven't been met. Understanding statuses helps you know what's possible at each stage and why certain actions might not be available.

Approvals Are Quality Gates - Approvals are checkpoints, not obstacles. They ensure that items meet standards, comply with requirements, and have proper authorization before proceeding. This protects all parties and maintains quality throughout the process. Understanding approvals helps you appreciate their value in ensuring quality and maintaining compliance.

Sequential Progression - Workflows progress sequentially through stages. You cannot skip steps or go backwards without proper authorization. This ensures that important steps aren't missed and that items progress in the correct order. Understanding sequential progression helps you know what needs to happen and in what order.

Role-Based Approval Authority - Different roles have authority to approve different items at different stages. Only facility agents can approve term sheets, only lenders can approve funding requests, etc. This ensures proper authorization and maintains workflow integrity. Understanding role-based authority helps you know who can approve what and when.

Rejection vs. Change Requests - Reviewers can reject items (stopping the workflow) or request changes (allowing improvement and resubmission). Understanding this distinction helps you know whether you need to start fresh or can make changes and continue. Change requests enable iterative improvement, while rejections require starting over.

Status Changes Are Permanent - Status changes are recorded and cannot be easily undone. This creates accountability and maintains audit trails. Make sure items are ready before moving to the next status. Understanding permanence helps you appreciate the importance of careful progression.

Complete History - All status changes and approvals are recorded with who made the change, when it happened, and what changed. This creates complete audit trails for compliance and accountability. Understanding history helps you appreciate how the platform maintains accountability and supports compliance.

Status Visibility - Statuses are visible to all relevant parties, providing transparency into process progression. Everyone can see where items are and what stage they're at. Understanding visibility helps you know how statuses communicate information to all parties.

Approval Decisions Are Documented - All approval decisions are recorded with who approved, when, and any comments or reasons. This creates accountability and supports compliance requirements. Understanding documentation helps you appreciate how the platform maintains accountability.

Automatic Enforcement - The platform enforces status and approval rules automatically. You don't need to remember to follow rules—the platform ensures proper operation automatically. Understanding automatic enforcement helps you appreciate how the platform simplifies compliance and ensures consistency.

Understanding this philosophy helps you work effectively within the platform's structure, appreciate why certain actions are available or disabled, and understand how statuses and approvals work together to ensure quality, compliance, and proper workflow progression. This understanding enables you to navigate the platform effectively and work efficiently within the structured workflow system.